



Happy Birthday YouTube!

This month our favorite, YouTube turned 8. Let's have a sweet cake and say "Happy Birthday, YouTube!"

About.me goes premium

It won't be available for free anymore. Now you can add your own domain name for US \$4 per month. Good deal, eh? What do you think? <http://www.about.me/>

Xbox One: All You Need To Know!

The Xbox reveal event hosted by Microsoft indeed lived up to its name, where the company showed off the console in its entirety, along with showcasing some of the amazing new features it will bring to the table.

Abhinav Lal

abhinav.lal@thinkdigit.com

The Xbox One: Designed to Kill

The Xbox One has been completely redesigned inside-and-out. The console looks pretty much like a black box, but with elegant cuts and fins for ventilation, and while it is slightly bigger than the previous generation Xbox devices, Microsoft says it runs at least four times quieter. The Kinect sensor and the controller too have received a redesign, with the sensor also going for the clean, industrial look, very similar to the console itself.

The controller, on the other hand, still retains its basic layout and shape, but has received many tweaks. The D-pad has improved, the joysticks now have a nice textured finish and the XYBA buttons have a new look. The real noticeable changes, however, are the fact that the battery compartment is now integrated into the controller, meaning no more awkward humps at the bottom. The other major change is that the new controller includes not two, but four vibration motors.

Hardware: Next Generation on Steroids

In an attempt to bring it at par with PC gaming, the first thing to change is the fact that the console is now running on x86 architecture (64-bit), meaning all our Xbox 360 games are



effectively incompatible with the new console. In exchange, Microsoft is offering some serious power under the hood.

For starters, the paltry 512MB of RAM that graces our current Xbox 360 models has been swapped out for a face-melting 8GB of RAM. There's a custom built AMD SoC on board that packs an 8-core CPU along with a DirectX 11.1 capable GPU. In order to keep the insides as slim as possible (we're assuming for better airflow and lower operating temperatures) and minimise parts, the 40 nanometre SoC features the CPU/GPU chip, the memory, the controller logic, the DRAM, and audio processors all built onto it. In comparison, this much horsepower is spread over two 90 nanometre chips on the Xbox 360. There's also a 500 GB hard drive and a custom built Blu-ray drive in there.

Microsoft hasn't revealed much about ports and connectivity except that it will sport an HDMI in and an HDMI out port. All USB ports will be USB 3. There's a redesigned Kinect sensor port as well, making us feel that the existing sensor will not be compatible with the new console. For internet connectivity, the Xbox One has the usual gigabit Ethernet port, along with three Wi-Fi (802.11n) antennae.

Big Brother, the New Kinect

The new Kinect sensor makes the old one look like a severely under-developed piece of tech. We start with the camera itself, which has gone from a resolution of 640x480 pixels in RGB colour space to full HD (1920x1080) in the RGB space. What this allows the sensor to now do is sense even the minutest of movements. It

can tell when you smile, when you rotate your wrists, it can measure the depth of your movements to a much finer degree, and for all the fitness enthusiasts, it can even monitor your heart rate. It also recognises the new Xbox controller and syncs player profiles accordingly, apart from resuming game you were last playing from where you left it off. The new Xbox One console will ship with the new Kinect sensor, instead of being a separate, expensive accessory.

An all-in-one console for your home

It was very clear from the very beginning that Microsoft was setting out to create a device that would soon become a permanent and necessary fixture in everyone's living rooms. While the Xbox 360 fulfilled that role rather beautifully, the Xbox One takes it to a whole new level. Remember that HDMI In port we mentioned earlier? Yes, that is essentially to take in cable input, instantly turning your gaming console into a DVR box. Microsoft mentions that the cable capabilities are limited to certified set top boxes, so whether it will work with our Indian providers such as Tata Sky, Airtel, Dish TV etc., is still not known. Regardless, there is a Blu-ray drive built into the console this time, so you can go through your movie collection on the Xbox One at ease.

For more details about the Xbox One, refer to our online coverage (<http://dgit.in/18hnmnV>)!